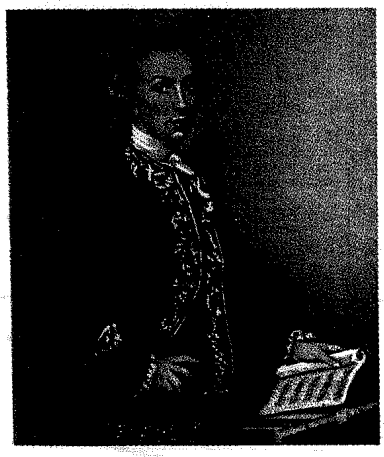

Haydn in 1762
(From a painting by Longhi)
Courtesy Brooklyn Museum

Franz Joseph Haydn was born in Rohrau, Austria, in 1732. His genius attracted attention when he was very young and he is often called the father of instrumental music. In his early thirties, he enjoyed the patronage and friendship of the wealthy Prince Esterhazy and in consequence, spent much time in Hungary. While there, he developed a keen interest in the music of the Hungarian gypsies. The composition below is an air from the last movement of Haydn's trio for piano, violin and 'cello, very properly called the "Gypsy Rondo". This music is characteristic of the Gypsy folk, full of light-heartedness and the joy of living. All of Haydn's work is characterized by simplicity, perfect finish, the avoidance of meaningless phrases, and firmness of design. Use clearly articulated finger legato in the right hand in playing the "Gypsy Rondo" and do not overlook the occasional staccato notes.

Theme from Gypsy Rondo

Haydn (1732-1809)

Presto

mf scherzando

cresc.

f

p